6.5 Elements of Design

The elements are the fundamentals of a design. These form the basic structure of a design conveying wide range of messages. It is very important for a designer to understand design elements as it finds its application in various fields like interior decoration, fashion designing, architecture, vegetable carving and visual arts. The basic elements of design are line, shape, form, colour and texture.

6.5.1 Line

Line is defined as an indication that gives a distance between two points. It is one of the most basic elements in art and design. Line is a mark made by the media such as brush, pencil, stick, pen, charcoal and paint. Lines are found everywhere as these are used in forming words, numbers and symbols. Line exists in nature as a structural feature. For example, lines on zebra, branch of a tree, mountain peaks, weaves and thunder (Figure 6.8).

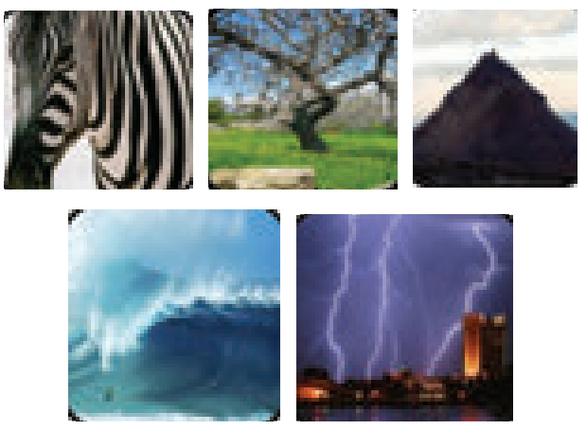


Figure 6.8 Lines in Nature

It also defines mass and volume. It may be continuous or discontinuous.

DO YOU KNOW?

What types of designs are suitable for tall figures?

As the horizontal lines on garments bring an optimal illusion that the figure is shorter, a tall person can go for these lines.



6.5.1.1 Types of Lines

The lines may be classified based on the curves introduced or continuity. (Figure6.9 and Table 6.1)

a) Based on Curves

A Straight Lines

These lines are very rigid, structural and formal in nature. They depict masculinity in designs. Straight lines are forceful leading the eye to the focal point. Example: Landscape designs (coconut trees). These are more suitable for male garments.

B. Curved Lines

These are more pleasing to the eyes. These are soft and depict femininity in designs. Curved lines are informal, and relaxed in nature. These are more suitable for female garments.

C. Zigzag Lines

A zigzag line is an angular shape characterized by sharp turns in alternating directions. These lines have short sharp turns and angles. It is said to be a tracing a path between two parallel lines.

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